

CRITICAL: Real Locations vs. Demo Data — Listing Status Distinction

The Problem

You are currently treating ALL seeded businesses as "staged." This is WRONG. There is a fundamental difference between real locations that exist in the physical world and demo/test data that was created for development purposes. They cannot share the same status, the same visibility rules, or the same lifecycle.

The Four Listing Statuses (Required)

Status	What It Is	Visible to Users?	Accumulates Reviews?	Example
live_unclaimed	A REAL business/landmark that EXISTS in the physical world. Has a real address. People can visit it TODAY. Shows the research description we provided until the owner claims it.	YES — live pin on map, interactive card, full experience	YES — community can review, endorse, "put your people on"	Apollo Theater, Sylvia's Restaurant, Schomburg Center
live_claimed	A real business whose OWNER has claimed their listing. They've added their own story video, updated their description, added photos. Fully active.	YES — full experience with owner-provided content	YES — full community interaction	(Future state — when a business owner claims their pin)
demo	FAKE test data created for development/test	NO — visible ONLY to accounts flagged as testers	NO — any test reviews are quarantined and	"Test Bakery," "Sample Barber Shop," any

	ing purposes. Does NOT exist in the real world. Created so testers could see how the app works without affecting real businesses.		never shown to real users	placeholder business
staged	Real data that is in the database but the CITY has not launched yet. The data is ready and waiting. When the city launches, these automatically promote to <code>live_unclaimed</code> .	NO — not visible until city launch	NO — not until promoted to live	A real restaurant in Denver (Denver hasn't launched yet)

The Lifecycle

Plain Text

DEMO DATA:

demo → permanently_hidden (when city launches with real data)

demo → deleted (cleanup, optional)

REAL DATA:

staged → live_unclaimed (when city launches)

live_unclaimed → live_claimed (when owner claims their listing)

Demo data NEVER becomes live. Real data NEVER becomes demo. They are completely separate tracks.

What This Means for the 497 Businesses Currently in the Database

Every single one of the 270 businesses we just added from the Cultural Guide are REAL. They exist. They have real addresses. People can walk in the door today. They should be:

- `staged` if their city hasn't launched yet
- `live_unclaimed` if their city IS launched (like Philadelphia)

They should NEVER be treated as demo data. They should NEVER be hidden from real users in a launched city. They should NEVER be deleted during a "cleanup."

What Happens to Demo Data When a City Launches

The moment a city goes live with real data:

1. All `demo` listings in that city are automatically set to `permanently_hidden`
 2. All `staged` real listings in that city are promoted to `live_unclaimed`
 3. Real users see ONLY real pins — never demo pins
 4. Tester accounts can still see demo pins (for ongoing QA) but they are clearly marked with a "DEMO" badge
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The Pin Experience for Each Status

`live_unclaimed` (Real business, no owner yet):

- Pin appears on map with correct designation icon (business, cultural_landmark, heritage_site, or dual)
- Tapping shows the profile card with:
 - Our research description (Layer 1 placeholder)
 - Community endorsements if any exist (Layer 2)
 - Cultural Ambassador content if any exists (Layer 3)
 - "Learn More" link to external URL if we provided one
 - "Is this your business? Claim it" button
- Community members CAN leave reviews, endorse, "put your people on"
- The listing is REAL and ACTIVE — it just hasn't been claimed by the owner yet

`live_claimed` (Owner has claimed):

- Same as above PLUS owner's story video, owner's photos, owner's updated description
- "Claim" button is replaced with owner verification badge

- Owner can manage their listing, respond to reviews, add Direct Commerce (if verified tier)

demo (Fake test data):

- ONLY visible to tester accounts
- Clearly marked with "DEMO — FOR TESTING ONLY" overlay
- Any reviews left on demo listings are tagged as test reviews
- Demo listings do NOT appear in search results for real users
- Demo listings do NOT count toward city statistics ("25 businesses in Charlotte")

staged (Real but city not launched):

- NOT visible to any users (including testers in that city context)
- Exists in database ready to go live
- Admin can preview staged data in a "City Preview" mode
- Automatically promotes to `live_unclaimed` when city launch is triggered

VERIFICATION REQUEST

To confirm you understand this distinction, please provide:

1. Show me 3 examples from your current database with their CORRECT listing_status:

For each, tell me:

- Business name
- City
- What status it CURRENTLY has
- What status it SHOULD have based on this document
- Why

2. Show me a side-by-side comparison:

Pick ONE demo business (like "Test Bakery" or whatever fake data exists) and ONE real business (like Apollo Theater or Sylvia's Restaurant) and show me:

Field	Demo Business	Real Business
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Name	?	?
listing_status	?	?
Visible to real users?	?	?
Can accumulate real reviews?	?	?
What happens at city launch?	?	?
Can an owner claim it?	?	?
data_source	?	?

3. Answer these questions:

1. If a real user in Philadelphia opens the app today, should they see Sylvia's Restaurant as a pin? (Yes/No and why)
2. If a real user in Philadelphia opens the app today, should they see "Test Bakery" as a pin? (Yes/No and why)
3. When Charlotte launches, what happens to the demo data in Charlotte?
4. When Charlotte launches, what happens to the 25+ real businesses we seeded for Charlotte?
5. Can a community member leave a review on Apollo Theater right now? Should that review persist forever?
6. Can a community member leave a review on "Test Bakery"? What happens to that review?

NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

1. Real locations are NEVER deleted during cleanup operations
2. Demo data is NEVER visible to real users
3. Reviews on real locations are PERMANENT and carry forward through all status changes
4. Reviews on demo data are QUARANTINED and never shown to real users
5. The app's business count ("25 businesses in Charlotte") ONLY counts `live_unclaimed` + `live_claimed` — never `demo` or `staged`
6. Search results ONLY return `live_unclaimed` + `live_claimed` — never `demo` or `staged`

7. When an owner claims a listing, our research description becomes "About this business (community sourced)" and moves below the owner's own description — it is NOT deleted
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MIGRATION REQUIRED

Run a migration that:

1. Identifies all DEMO/TEST businesses currently in the database (anything with fake names, placeholder data, or test addresses)
2. Sets their `listing_status` to `demo`
3. Sets their `data_source` to `demo_seed`
4. Identifies all REAL businesses from the Cultural Guide data
5. Sets their `listing_status` to `staged` (for unlaunched cities) or `live_unclaimed` (for Philadelphia, which is already live)
6. Sets their `data_source` to `manus_cultural_guide`
7. Confirms the count: how many demo vs. how many real in each city

Report back with the counts before and after.